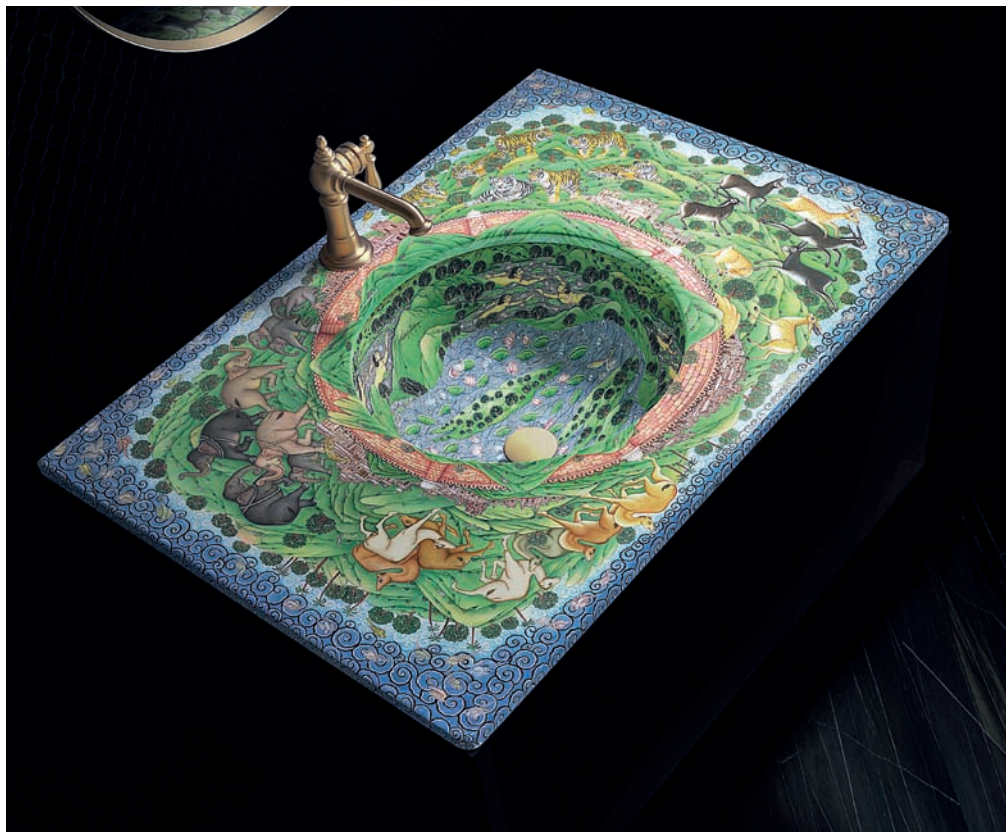




Kohler's Quila range of limited-edition handcrafted washbasins have art by Jai Prakash



Roca's Prisma mirrors are fitted quickly remove any condensati

to automated spritzer wands, there is enough tech in the bathroom to get a geek excited.

Take, for instance, Kohler's Veil intelligent toilet. Priced at ₹6.4 lakh, it comes with a control pad for cleansing features—you can have a pulsating wash that massages your bottom or a spiral spray for cleansing a broader area, and of course warm air dries your bottom and the toilet—all at the touch of a button. Not only does the toilet flush automatically, but the seat cover also opens and closes, sensing your distance. The nozzle is sterilised after each use and sanitised with a UV light. Oh! And there is also an automatic deodoriser that keeps your bathroom fresh.

India's sanitaryware market is growing significantly. Valued at

\$1.06 billion in 2020, it is expected to reach \$1.65 billion by 2027, at a CAGR of 6.7 per cent over the forecast period 2021–2027.

Says Salil Sadanandan, President-Kohler Brand South Asia, Middle East & Sub-Saharan Africa, "The pandemic has led to people spending more time at home. While we have seen people spend money on doing up their home office, they are also spending a lot more money on their bathrooms." Sadanandan says that in spite of the high-ticket prices of products such as the intelligent toilet, there is great demand. "We are more than doubling our sales every year in the intelligent toilet category."

Globally, Kohler has also introduced a fully-connected bathroom that is voice activated. Walk in and

say, "Shower on, 35 degrees for 15 minutes" and you are all set. You could also determine how many litres of water you want to use and the shower will shut down accordingly. While a prototype is on display at the Kohler experience centre in Mumbai, the product hasn't come to India yet as the company is trying to get the data ecosystem in place.

Sadanandan says that because of social media, there is increased expenditure on home improvement. "There is a great desire for self-expression among our consumers, particularly women. And that is making a difference in how we design bathrooms. There is a desire to show how great your house actually looks." Keeping that in mind, Kohler has launched Quila, a range of limited-edition